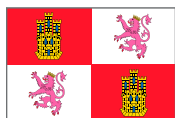


Spain: Regional flags



CASTILLA Y LEÓN

This flag has been used by Castilla y León since 1248. It depicts the union of Castilla (castle) and León (lion). It was adopted for the region in 1989.



EXTREMADURA

This flag was adopted in 1985, but the colors are traditional regional colors. Green is for fidelity, white for truth, and black for courage.



LA RIOJA

The upper red stripe was originally to be in the color of Rioja wine, but is now simply red. The colors are taken from the arms.



MURCIA

The four castles recall Murcia's links with Castilla and the seven crowns, the seven regions of the province.



VALENCIA

The stripes recall Valencia's links with Catalonia and the stylized crown, its period of independence.



**CATALONIA
(CATALUNYA)**

The flag, adopted in 1932, has been used since the 13th century and has the same origin as that of Aragón. It was outlawed from 1939 to 1975.



GALICIA

Based on a traditional Galician design, white and blue are the colors of the Virgin Mary. The arms reflects loyalty to the Catholic Church.



MADRID

The flag, adopted in 1983, is in the traditional color of Castilla. The seven white stars, from the arms, are for the seven districts of the region.



NAVARRRE

The red field and golden chains of Navarre date from the 14th century. The current flag was adopted in 1982.